PARENT GUIDANCE · DESIGN SYSTEM

Buttons

Design guidelines · Parent Guidance · Updated October 15, 2026

Every action button in the prototype comes from a single system (teal, 8px, Poppins semibold 14px, teal dark on hover), implemented in the `Button.tsx` component (section 2.4).

2.1 Styles

Style	Look	When
Primary	`pg-teal` background, white text; `pg-teal-dark` on hover	The main action of the section: "View course", "Book a session", "Submit question"
Secondary	White background, 1px `pg-teal` border, `pg-teal-dark` text; `pg-tint` background on hover	Supporting action next to a Primary ("Cancel", "View details")
Tertiary	`pg-teal-dark` text only, underlined on hover	Low-priority actions: "See more", "Skip"
Inverse	White background, `pg-navy` text; `pg-cream` on hover	Main action **on navy, teal or sage backgrounds**
Inverse secondary	`white/5` background, `white/20` border, white text; `white/10` on hover	Supporting action on dark backgrounds

> **One Primary per section.** If there are more actions, they become Secondary or Tertiary.

There are no navy or sage buttons: navy is the color of text and navigation, not of action. That way users learn that teal means "I can click this".

On a **sage** background (banners such as "Not sure which resource is right for you?") the main action is **Inverse**: teal on sage is barely visible.

2.2 Sizes

Size	Height	Padding	Text	When
S	32px	`px-4`	14px / 600	Dense UI: toolbars, pagination, "Register" in event rows. On mobile, only if the button is full width
M	40px (48px on mobile)	`px-5`	14px / 600	**Default**
L	48px	`px-7`	16px / 600	Hero CTAs and key screens on mobile

- `rounded-pg-md` radius (8px) on every size.
- The **pill** shape (`rounded-full`) is reserved for chips, badges, filters and the search bar. Not for action buttons.
- Optional icon on the right (`→` arrow or 16px Material Outlined icon) with `gap-2` . If the icon is decorative, it gets `aria-hidden="true"` .
- `w-full` only inside cards or on mobile.

2.3 States

State	Primary	Secondary
Default	`bg-pg-teal text-white`	`bg-white border-pg-teal text-pg-teal-dark`
Hover	`bg-pg-teal-dark`	`bg-pg-tint`
Pressed	`scale 0.97` (motion `whileTap`)	same
Focus	2px `pg-teal-dark` ring with a 2px offset	same
Loading	16px spinner + "Sending…", `aria-busy="true"` , no clicks	same
Disabled	`bg-pg-line text-pg-slate` , `not-allowed` cursor	`border-pg-line text-pg-slate`

Visible focus is applied globally in `src/styles/accessibility.css` : every link, button or field shows a 2px teal dark ring with a white halo when navigating with the keyboard, on light and dark backgrounds. New components don't need to add focus classes.

2.4 Component

The prototype's buttons use `src/components/ui/Button.tsx` :

Component	For	Example
`<Button>`	Actions (submit, open, download)	`<Button variant="secondary" size="s" onClick={…}>Today</Button>`
`<ButtonLink>`	Navigation inside the app (`react-router`)	`<ButtonLink to="/ask-a-therapist">View Answer</ButtonLink>`
`<ButtonAnchor>`	External links, `mailto:` , `tel:` , `sms:` and `#` anchors	`<ButtonAnchor href="tel:988" variant="inverse" size="l">Call 988</ButtonAnchor>`
`buttonClass()`	Just the classes, for elements that can't use the components	`className={buttonClass({ variant: "secondary" })}`

- Props: `variant` (`primary` by default, `secondary` , `tertiary` , `inverse` , `inverse-secondary`) and `size` (`s` , `m` by default, `l`). `<Button>` also accepts `loading` .
- They all have `whileTap={{ scale: 0.97 }}` and no `whileHover` scaling; hover changes color only.
- `className` is for layout (`w-full` , `mt-4` , `shrink-0`), not for changing colors, radii or sizes.

- Exception: the "Search" button inside a pill-shaped search bar may use `rounded-full`, because it is part of the bar.
- In newsletters, the button sits **inside** the input box (with `p-2` and `gap-2`), not glued to its edge.

Controls that are not action buttons

These elements have their own style and do **not** use `<Button>`:

Control	Style
Filter chips	`rounded-full text-xs font-medium px-4 py-2`; active `bg-pg-navy text-white`, inactive `bg-pg-cream-dark text-pg-slate`, with `aria-pressed`
"Featured" (sort) menu	`rounded-pg-md bg-pg-cream-dark text-xs font-medium px-4 py-2`, 14px `ListFilter` (filter_list) + `ChevronDown` (expand_more) icons, centered with the label
Segmented control (Month/List, Day/Week/Month)	`bg-pg-tint-soft` container; active option is white with `shadow-pg-card` and `aria-pressed`
Numeric pagination	32–40px squares; current page in navy or teal; Prev/Next as `<Button variant="secondary" size="s">`
Icon-only buttons	32–40px, `rounded-pg-md`, `aria-label` required (calendar arrows, close, menu)

2.5 Accessibility

- Use `<button>` for actions and `<a>` for navigation. Never `<div onClick>`.
- Touch area of at least **48px** high on mobile: size M grows to 48px automatically (8px grid: 32 / 40 / 48).
- External links (`target="_blank"`) must say so: an external-link icon + hidden text "(opens in a new tab)".
- Icon-only buttons get an `aria-label` ("Close", "Menu").
- Disabled: explain why with nearby helper text if it isn't obvious.
- On the **Get Help** page (crisis lines), call/text buttons use `<a href="tel:…">` and `<a href="sms:…">` in size L, so they are easy to tap in a moment of stress.

2.6 Do / Don't

Do

- One Primary per section, in teal.
- Short labels that start with a verb: "View course", "Book a session".
- The same size for every button in a row.

Don't

- Navy, sage or mist buttons.
- Mixing pill and rectangular buttons on the same screen.

- `whileHover` scaling above 1.02 on buttons: it feels unstable.
- Button text at 10–11px.